

GUIDE 3 OF 3

Build Status, Commercial Findings, and What to Offer on the Day

Everything built, what is verified, three things found in your own bid documents, ten options to offer, and the implementation plan for the day after they sign.

Vertex ERP for Shahjalal Islami Bank PLC · prepared by Harvest Partners (HK) Limited · 19 September 2026

50 SCREENS	64 DATABASE TABLES	43 CONTROL ASSERTIONS	23 + 3 STAFF + VENDOR LOGINS	0 NETWORK CALLS AT RUNTIME
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What is verified, on the current code

Check	Result	What it proves
Control assertions	43 / 43	Every control refuses when it should and permits when it should, tested directly against the database. Was 34 before the Shariah work.
Every screen	96 / 96	Signs in as each role, opens every screen that role can reach. Zero errors, zero dead links.
The demo thread	24 / 24	A real browser driven through the whole story, five people, requisition to payment, including all three refusals. Unchanged by this week's work.
Offline	34 / 34	Every page renders with all network access blocked. No page even attempts an external request.
Projector	9 / 9	Legible at 1280×720, nothing smaller than 11px, nothing cut off.

The six controls the Bank will actually test

Control	What it does	Where it is enforced
Maker-checker	The person who raises or enters something can never approve it.	Inside the database transaction, before the role check. No route bypasses it.
Two-envelope seal	A bidder's price cannot be read until technical evaluation completes.	One file is the only code path that can read a price. While sealed the amounts never leave the database — not hidden in the interface, not filtered after the fact. RFQ clause 1.9.
PO matches approval	A work order cannot exceed the approved quantity or add an unapproved item.	The refusal names the item, the approved quantity and the attempted quantity.
Three-way match	An invoice bills only what was received and accepted, at the ordered price.	Mismatches listed line by line; the invoice cannot move to matched.
Hash-chained audit log	Each entry carries a fingerprint of the one before it.	Append-only. Altering any historical row breaks the chain and the Verify button turns red.

Shariah authority new	Only a member of the Shariah Supervisory Committee can record a Shariah decision.	Not even the system administrator. Same reasoning as the audit trail: a decision recorded by anyone else would not be a decision of the Committee.
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Three findings from your own bid documents

1. You are paid nothing for the demo, and nothing on signing

RFQ clause 1.19, read from the scanned original:

“No advance payment will be made. Full payment will be made after successful delivery of the solution at live environment after deducting 5% Security Money & VAT/Tax/AIT as per prevailing Government rules.”

There is no demo fee, no mobilisation payment and no milestone schedule anywhere in the four documents. Payment comes once, after the system is live — 60 working days from work order with minor customisation, 90 with integration — and 5% of it is then withheld for a further year under clause 1.15.

On top of that, clause 1.5 requires

2% of the bid price as bid security

lodged with the offer (BDT 6,40,000 on a 3.2 crore bid), and clause 1.14 requires

5% performance security

on accepting the work order (BDT 16,00,000). Both are money out before any money comes in.

Plan your cash on this basis.

If somebody told you the demo triggers a payment, get it in writing, because it is not in the RFQ.

2. Annexure-C has a figures-versus-words error in the AMC line — and I over-stated it last time

SL	Particulars	Price in BDT	Price in words
1.	Solution cost with 1 year warranty	BDT 3,20,00,000/-	Three Crore Twenty Lacs Only agrees
2.	Per year AMC cost	BDT 50,00,000/-	BDT 50 Thousand Only does not agree

The correction to what I told you before.

I first flagged this as urgent on the assumption the RFQ carried a standard “words prevail over figures” clause. I have since read all four pages of terms, and

there is no such clause

. The error is real and worth correcting, but it is a clerical slip the Bank would most likely just query, not a trap that binds you to BDT 50,000 a year. Correct it; do not panic about it.

Send a one-paragraph clerical correction to the procurement contact before demo day, stating the AMC price is BDT 50,00,000 (Fifty Lakh Only) as shown in figures. Volunteering it reads as diligence. Note also that clause 1.3 calls AMC *optional*, so this is a smaller exposure than it first appeared.

3. The demo still does not run on the stack you quoted

Component	Annexure-A commitment	What the demo runs on
Operating system	Linux (Ubuntu Server LTS 22.04+)	Runs on Linux, Windows and Mac compatible
Language	Node.js with TypeScript	Node.js with TypeScript matches
Backend framework	NestJS	Next.js differs
Database	PostgreSQL 15+	SQLite , a single file differs
Architecture	Three tier, load balanced, DC / DR / Far-DR	One process on a laptop differs

Have one sentence ready: *“The demonstration is condensed to a single portable node so it runs on a laptop with no network. The production build follows the three-tier architecture and the stack quoted in Annexure-A.”* That is true, it is normal, and the in-app About screen says it in writing before anyone has to ask.

Ten things to offer on the day

Offer these as a **roadmap you are willing to discuss**, not as scope you are giving away in the room. Read the warning underneath before you decide how generous to be.

Option	What it is	Size	Why it lands
Internal assistant over the Bank's own procedures	Staff ask a question in plain language — “what is the approval limit for a post-facto requisition?”, “which vendors are enlisted for civil works?”, “where is REQ/CSD/2026/0847?” — and get an answer drawn from the Bank's own procurement policy, its workflow configuration and its live data. Answers cite the document and clause they came from.	Medium	Runs against the Bank's own content only. Never invents an approval limit: if the policy does not say, it says so and names who to ask.
Procurement integrity detection	Split-PO detection (a purchase broken into pieces to stay under an approval threshold), bid-rigging signals, price drift against last purchase, vendor concentration, and approval-velocity anomalies.	Medium	This one returns money. It is the strongest argument for not being the lowest bid.
Bangladesh Bank inspection pack	One button: every procurement decision in a date range with its approval chain, committee composition, comparative statement and the audit-chain verification result, as a single signed document.	Small	Named in Annexure-A already. Nobody else will offer it.
Bangla language interface	Full Bangla alongside English, switchable per user. Branch staff are the largest user population and the ones least served by an English-only system.	Medium	Drives actual adoption at branch level, which is where ERP rollouts usually fail.
Mobile approvals	A phone view for approvers only. A DMD approving a requisition from a car is the difference between a two-day cycle and a two-hour one.	Medium	Same permission model and same maker-checker. No separate app to maintain.
Delegation of authority as a first-class object	The DoP matrix as a screen the Bank edits, with leave delegation, acting arrangements and automatic escalation when an approver is away.	Medium	Banks live and die by the DoP. Today it is expressed as workflow thresholds; this makes it explicit.
Vendor performance scoring	Automatic scoring from delivery punctuality, rejection rate at goods receipt, invoice mismatch rate and penalty history, feeding back into enlistment and evaluation.	Small	Turns the data already being captured into an enlistment decision.
Budget forecasting and commitment accounting	Budget consumed, committed (approved but not yet invoiced) and available, with a forward view of where a head will land at year end.	Medium	“Committed” is the number Finance actually needs and almost never has.
Document OCR and auto-indexing	Scanned challans, invoices and trade licences read automatically, indexed and matched to the right record, with expiry dates extracted into the register.	Medium	Most of this Bank's paper arrives as a scan. We proved the technique reading their own RFQ.
Shariah audit reporting for the Supervisory Committee	A period report for the Shariah Supervisory Committee: every procurement decision it ruled on, the structures assigned, conditions imposed and whether they were met.	Small	Extends what is already built. The Committee currently has no system-generated view of procurement at all.

Read this before you say “we will do anything, no extra fee”

I understand the instinct and I would not tell you to be stingy. But that exact sentence, said in that room, is dangerous, and the reason is in the Bank's own terms:

- You are contractually bound to deliver in
60 or 90 working days
from the work order (clause 1.16). Extra scope does not extend that clock.
- Late delivery costs
1% of the work order value per week
(clause 1.18). At 5% the Bank may forfeit the performance security, the security money *and* the work order itself.
- You receive
no money at all
until go-live (clause 1.19). Every additional week of scope is a week you are funding yourself.

So “we will do anything for free” converts directly into: later delivery, then penalty, then forfeiture. The generosity is real; the delivery risk is what kills the firm.

Say this instead.

It gives away nothing and sounds more confident, not less:

“Everything in Annexure-A and Annexure-B is fixed scope at the price quoted, delivered in the window quoted. Beyond that, here are ten things we have already thought about for you. Tell us which one matters most and we will build it into the roadmap at no change to the licence price — we would rather agree the sequence with you than sell you modules.”

That is a real commitment, it costs you nothing today, and it puts you in a conversation about priorities rather than a conversation about price. If you want to give one thing away outright on the day, give the

inspection pack

— it is small, it is specific to them, and it makes internal audit an ally.

Why we cannot do certain Annexure items today

None of these is a build failure. Six were declared in the submitted Annexure-B as needing customisation, and the Bank has those answers on record already. Give the reason plainly — the reasons are good ones.

Item	Where	Why not today	What to say
Payment gateway — anywhere it appears	Modules 3, 5, 6, 7, 18 and 24	There is no gateway to connect to yet. The Bank has not named its payment service provider, and the integration is specific to whichever one it picks — endpoints, settlement, reconciliation and PCI scope all change with the choice.	Declared as Need Customization in the submitted Annexure-B. The answer is already on record and costs nothing to repeat.
Building management hardware — lifts, HVAC, generators	Module 12	This means talking to equipment already bolted into their buildings. Whether that is possible at all depends on what each site has and whether it exposes an API or a protocol like BACnet or Modbus. Some will, some are twenty years old and will not.	Declared as Need Customization. Honest answer on stage: a site survey during implementation tells us which sites can be read automatically and which need manual entry.
CCTV operational status	Module 12	Same problem. Reading whether a camera is alive means the CCTV system exposing that, and most installed systems in this market do not.	We answered Workaround Available, not Fully Complied — meaning a manual status register rather than a live feed.
Real-time cross-vendor price comparison	Module 2	It needs live price feeds from vendors. That is a commercial arrangement with each vendor before it is a technical problem: somebody has to agree to publish prices.	Declared as Need Customization. What works today is last purchase price, which is already live in the demo.
Prescription records	Module 14	Clinical data about named employees carries privacy obligations well beyond ordinary procurement data — who can see it, how long it is kept, how it is separated from HR.	Declared as Need Customization. This is a policy decision for the Bank's HR and compliance functions, then a configuration.
CBS, HRMS, DMS, IAM, e-mail and SMS integration	Annexure-A section 4, Module 24 (xxvi)	We have no access to any of these systems and will not until after contract. The integrations screen lists every planned endpoint and marks each Not connected, which is the truthful position.	Not a gap in the build. This is Phase 3 of the implementation plan and the middleware tier already exists in the architecture to receive it.
Full 25-module depth	Modules 4, 5, 11 to 20	Four days of build. Nineteen modules run end to end or hold real working data; the rest are populated registers rather than complete workflows.	Every one of them is contracted and delivered in the 60 to 90 working day window. A demo is not the product, and the Bank knows that.

What happens the day after they sign

This is the question that decides whether they believe you can actually deliver. Walk it in order; it should sound like something you have done before, because the structure is already in your Annexure-A narrative.

0 Work order and mobilisation

Week 1

Contract signed, 5% performance security lodged, project manager and technical account lead named, a kick-off with Common Services and IT Division in the same room. We ask for one thing: the names of the people who own each decision.

Nothing technical happens this week and that is deliberate.

1 Requirements finalisation and sign-off

Weeks 1-3

We walk the Bank's actual procurement policy and delegation matrix and configure the workflow engine against them — in the builder, on screen, with Common Services watching. Integration endpoints confirmed with IT Division. Hardware sizing confirmed. Signed off before a line of configuration is locked.

This is where most ERP projects quietly fail. Doing it in the builder with the client in the room is why ours will not.

2 Core platform and module configuration

Weeks 3-8

The core — users, roles, permissions, workflow engine, audit trail — then the functional modules in Annexure-B order, with the deep procurement spine first. The Bank sees a running system at the end of every second week, not at the end.

The demo you are showing on Monday already is this layer. It is not a prototype we throw away.

3 Integration

Weeks 6-10

The middleware tier connects to CBS, HRMS, DMS, IAM and the e-mail and SMS gateways. Each one is tested on its own before anything is tested end to end, so a failure has one obvious cause.

Runs in parallel with Phase 2, which is how 90 working days is achievable rather than optimistic.

4 Data migration

Weeks 8-11

Vendors, enlistment records, open contracts, asset register, stock balances and budget heads move across. Every migrated record is reconciled against the source and signed off by the Bank before go-live, not after.

The question nobody asks in a demo and everybody asks in month two.

5 User acceptance testing

Weeks 10-12

A dedicated UAT environment mirroring production, with acceptance criteria agreed in advance so sign-off is a checklist and not an argument.

Committed in Annexure-A section 13.

6 Training and go-live

Weeks 12-13

Three separate streams as promised: IT Division on administration and DR, Common Services on workflow and user management, branch and head office on day-to-day use. Then phased go-live, division by division.

Training materials stay with the Bank, so new joiners do not need us.

7 Warranty

12 months from go-live

24x7 helpdesk, SLA-backed response tiers, and any change required by a regulatory shift at no cost. The 5% security money is released at the end of this period.

RFQ clauses 1.14, 1.15 and 1.17.

The line that closes it

“You will see a running system inside three weeks, not at the end. Every fortnight after that you see it again. If it is going wrong you will know in week four, not week twelve — and the workflow configuration that makes that possible is the same screen we just showed you, which your own administrators drive.”

What I would do with the time that is left

Priority	Task	Why
1	Send the Annexure-C clerical correction	Two minutes of writing, and it is not a build task.
2	Walk the demo thread twice on your own laptop	Until you have done it yourself you do not have a demo, you have my word that there is one.
3	Rehearse the four refusals until they are automatic	Self-approval, the sealed price, the over-quantity work order, and the administrator who cannot sign for the Shariah Committee.
4	Decide your answer to “what is it built on”	One sentence, ready, not improvised.
5	Decide how generous you are willing to be, before the room asks	Decide it now, calmly, rather than in front of them.